



A cat simulator!

Garbage Cat is a 2D game that lets you be a cat that loves irritating its owner. <http://dgit.in/1EelZU7>

Good times return?

Popular gaming company Nintendo reported the first profit since 2011. Read more: <http://dgit.in/1S1lnMc>

Budget smartphones

HOW WE TESTED

Before we get to that, let us clear that question nagging you right now. Is this a fair comparison? Well, we argued about this amongst the team here and decided that it is. Of course there is a gap between the sub-7k smartphones and those costing around 15k, but that doesn't mean any of them are bad. In fact, in today's market, an inexpensive smartphone has a better shot at giving more value for money than a more expensive one does.

The tests we did gave us our picks, and we went ahead and chose one of our own as well. The aim of this comparison is not just to establish the best smartphone in these price segments, but also to provide perspective. It will tell you how close or behind the phone you were choosing is and whether you may still go for it.

Onto the task at hand then, we used nine smartphones for this comparison — the Xiaomi Redmi 2, Lenovo A6000 Plus, Moto E 4G, Yu Yuphoria, Karbonn Titanium Mach One, Karbonn Titanium Mach Two, Xiaomi Mi4i, Asus Zenfone 2 (2GB RAM, 1080p display) and BlackBerry Z3.

There are some big names here, formidable competitors and phones that we've received a lot of queries about.

How exactly did we test these little gadgets though? By now you would know that we have our processes set for this purpose. We started out with synthetic benchmarks, gaining a completely objective view on each of these smartphones performance potential. We tested both the CPU and GPU to figure out which one of these could do the best and which ones were lagging behind.

Next we moved on to test the camera performance of the devices. The camera is an important aspect of smartphones today, with each having its own merits and demerits, while some are just plain better than others. We took the phone into different light conditions, including, bright sunlight, low light, fluorescent light and the dreaded low light conditions. We took the same images with each of these devices and compared them side by side on a calibrated display to find out what was what.

The next important task to accomplish was to test out the battery life on these smartphones. We used a combination of our own in-house test, which we have been using for years, combined with the Geekbench 3 Battery Test to determine how long the battery on these phones can last.

We also compared the display on these devices using a combination of basic tests that have been explained in the how to section in this issue, along with benchmarks and other screen tests. The emphasis was on viewing angles and accurate colour reproduction, while we also considered the overall brightness of the screen.

A careful examination was also made of the overall build quality of these smartphones, taking into account the quality of material used and finishing on the products.

With all that taken into account, we fed in the numbers to our tried and tested algorithms and came out with our winners. Here's how it panned out.



Karbonn Titanium MACH ONE

he or she's making is actually worth the money. That's not to say the 7610 was a bad phone, it had its merits, but many or most of us never really took the time to find that out in the rush to go buy it off the shelf.

Behold, the new generation, where a company can not just come in with a smartphone that looks good, expecting to sell it. Nor is it as easy to sell jargon in India as it used to be. The consumer today is seriously more educated, knowing what compromises they want to make and which ones they need to make for a phone to fit their exacting budget.

This, accompanied by the fact that the budget and affordable smartphone segments offer real quality nowadays has made these segments much more important than the flagships out there. Yes, a Samsung Galaxy S6 and LG G4 still make the news,

but they aren't quite as important as they used to be, simply because a lot of the advanced features sported by past flag-



ships have percolated down to low-end or budget smartphones, and this has bridged the gap between high-end phones and low-end smartphones.

That brings us to the topic of this story. It seems this is